

1 GAME OVERVIEW

Solo/cooperative dice-and-card puzzle for 1-2 players. Build all six airships before the six resource decks and Display run out.

- Goal: complete each Ship with 1 Blueprint, 1 Material, and 1 Crew.
- Win: flip all six Ship tokens to their Flying side.
- Typical play: about 15 minutes; light complexity.

3 STRUCTURE OF A TURN

1. ROLL

Roll all six dice. Match a result shown at the top of a Display card.



REROLL

To reroll any dice, discard 1 Display card to its matching discard pile. Do



2. ACQUIRE

Take exactly 1 matching Resource card, or skip Acquire only when the



3. REPLENISH

Refill only empty Display spaces from their matching decks. Existing

Risk reminder: every discarded Display card shortens t

2 SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- A. Place all 6 Ship tokens Project-side up; take all 6 dice.
- B. Place the 3 Pixie tokens beside the Ships.
- C. Select the 48 base-game Resource cards using the base-game indicator.
- D. Separate cards into 6 decks by the letter combination on each back; shuffle each deck.
- E. Arrange decks in one row. Leave a discard area behind each matching deck.
- F. Reveal the top card of every deck. These 6 face-up cards form the Display.
- G. Below the Display, reserve areas for Workshop 1, Workshop 2, Pulpit, and Reserve.
- H. Optional difficulty: return 1-3 Pixies to the box.

COMPONENT LEGEND

Ships = projects

Display = available cards

Pulpit = 1 Book

Pixies = die wild changes

Workshops = builds

Reserve = stored Elements

4 LARGE TABLE SETUP



Example table arrangement. Keep each discard pile paired with its deck and leave clear areas for Workshops, Pulpit, Reserve, Ships, Pixies, and dice.

1 KEY MECHANICS / RULES

- Roll requirements: sets need not use different values. AA+BB may be two pairs of the same number. A+B+C+D+E is 1-5 or 2-6.
- Workshops: each holds at most one Blueprint, one Material, and one Crew for one specific Ship. Blueprint and Material may arrive in either order; Crew must be last.
- Acquire limit: take only one Resource card in Phase 2.
- If an acquired Element cannot enter a Workshop, discard it unless a Book is spent to place it in Reserve.
- Reserve: unlimited Elements; move them to Workshops at any time.
- Pixie: after rolling, spend one to change one die to any face. Multiple Pixies may be used in one Roll phase.
- Discard piles may be examined at any time. Refill the Display only in Phase 3.

BOOK / PULPIT EFFECTS

ROLL	Discard Book: reroll any dice up to 3 times.
ACQUIRE	Discard Book: place acquired Element in Reserve.
ANY PHASE	Discard Book: return up to 2 discarded Elements from one pile to that deck top.

2 PROGRESS + VICTORY

BASE GAME HAS NO POINT SCORE

Track progress by completed Ships and remaining cards. Each completed Ship is a victory milestone, not a point value.

BUILDING A SHIP

1. Match a Blueprint and Material.
2. Add the compatible Crew last.
3. Flip the matching Ship to Flying.
4. Discard all 3 Elements to original piles.
5. Workshop becomes available again.

WIN

Complete all six Ships before resources are exhausted.

LOSE

If all six Resource decks and the Display are empty before all Ships are complete.

TIEBREAKERS

None. Aerion is cooperative: the team wins or loses.

3 STRATEGY + END GAME

GOOD HABITS

- Protect scarce matching Elements; do not chase every attractive card.
- Use both Workshops to pursue different Ships and preserve flexibility.
- Keep a Book ready when Reserve access or discard recovery could prevent waste.
- Check all obtainable cards before paying for a reroll.

COMMON MISTAKES

- Refilling immediately after each discard instead of waiting for Phase 3.
- Placing Crew before Blueprint and Material.
- Acquiring more than one card in a turn.
- Forgetting that rerolls consume Display cards.

COMPETITIVE TIPS

- Use Pixies to finish high-value combinations, not merely improve a weak roll.
- Recover two Elements from a depleted deck to rebuild its draw pile.
- Balance short-term acquisition against preserving enough cards to finish six Ships.

4 END OF GAME CHECK

All 6 Ships Flying? WIN.
Decks + Display empty first? LOSE.
Two players: each must build their own 3 Ships.

TWO PLAYERS

- Randomly give each player 3 Ship tokens; experienced player starts. Alternate complete turns.
- Each player has 1 Workshop, 1 Pulpit, and 1 Reserve. Add a third shared Workshop.
- Cards cannot enter the other player’s personal areas. Both players may use the shared Workshop.
- The player owning a Ship token must add the Crew to complete that Ship. Each player must build their own 3 Ships.

1 FLAGSHIP

Add Flagship + 2 randomly determined Factory cards. Build Flagship with all 3 Materials and both Crews; Crews are last. Complete it in addition to six Ships.

2 HOURGLASSES

Shuffle 24 Hourglasses into matching decks. Acquire six different Hourglasses, one from each deck. Discard any remaining in Display at start of Replenish.

3 STONE CLOUDS

Shuffle 12 Hammer Birds into decks; place 6 intact Clouds. Replace Acquire with Demolish when dice plus birds total at least 30. Each 30 points flips or discards one Cloud; destroy all six.

EXPANSION MODULES

4 PIERS

Shuffle 12 Workers into decks and add 3 Piers. Workers may enter Payroll for up to 3 rerolls. Pay one with Phase 2 total 26+. Build one Pier with five of a kind. Win only with all Piers built and Payroll empty.

5 HAMMER BIRD EGGS

Shuffle 12 Eggs into decks. Eggs cannot be discarded from Display. Spend acquired Eggs to reveal that many cards from one deck and choose one for Display. Special defeat: if only Eggs begin your turn, acquire one or lose.

6 HELLKITE

Create 6 Outpost/Lair stacks; pawn starts leftmost. The current Outpost blocks its shown Resource type. Replace Acquire with Hunt at dice total 15 or less to destroy the current card. Defeat every Outpost and Lair.

MODULE CHOOSER

More powers
More tempo pressure
Alternate dice totals
Risky rerolls + obligations
Deck manipulation
Moving restriction puzzle

Flagship
Hourglasses
Stone Clouds
Piers
Eggs
Hellkite

Every chosen module adds its own victory or defeat condition.